



Programs for Ontario schools

Independent schools sit outside the publicly funded mental health support system. No board mental health lead, no ministry-funded programming, no implementation coach. These programs build that layer — student sessions, staff PD, and parent evenings, priced for schools without a district budget behind them.

The programs

Holding the Room: De-escalation and Dysregulated Students

Staff leave with a sequence they can run during an incident, and a method for getting the other twenty-nine students back afterwards.

Audience Teaching staff, educational assistants, and school leadership

Duration Half day (3 hours)

Format On-site or virtual

Group size Up to 30, or up to 60 at the higher rate

Participants leave able to:

- Run a four-step de-escalation sequence from memory, under time pressure
- Adjust proximity, volume, and posture deliberately rather than by instinct
- Recover the attention of the rest of the class within two minutes of an incident ending
- Decide in the moment whether to hold, hand over, or remove, and act on it

Half day \$1,200 (up to 30 staff) · \$1,600 (up to 60) · Virtual \$900

Friendship, Conflict and Repair

Students leave able to spot the four moves that wreck a friendship and run a repair conversation without an adult mediating it.

Audience Students, Grades 6–9

Duration 75 minutes

Format On-site classroom scale, or virtual

Group size Capped at 30 so the practice segment works

Participants leave able to:

- Name the four interaction patterns that predict a friendship breaking down
- Catch one of those patterns in their own behaviour and substitute a different move
- Run a repair conversation using a three-step structure, having practised it aloud
- Distinguish a conflict worth repairing from a friendship worth stepping back from

From \$400

Staying in the Work: Burnout, Boundaries and Staff Wellbeing

Staff leave with one boundary they have actually decided to hold, rather than a list of self-care suggestions they will ignore.

Audience All school staff, including non-teaching staff and leadership

Duration 90-minute PD slot or half day (3 hours)

Format On-site or virtual

Group size Whole staff for the PD slot; capped at 30 for the half day

Participants leave able to:

- Distinguish burnout from ordinary tiredness using the three components it is actually made of
- Identify which of their own pressures are structural and which are genuinely theirs to change
- Choose and write down one boundary, in specific behavioural terms, rather than as an intention
- Say a prepared sentence that declines an additional demand without damaging a relationship

90-minute PD slot \$650 · Half day \$1,100 · Virtual 90 min \$450

Steady: Understanding Anxiety and Building Coping Skills

Students leave able to name what anxiety is doing in their body and use three specific techniques for bringing it down.

Audience Students, Grades 4–6, 7–8, or 9–12 (written separately for each band)

Duration 60–75 minutes

Format On-site assembly or classroom scale, or virtual

Group size Single class up to a full grade cohort

Participants leave able to:

- Name what is happening physically during anxiety, in plain language, without pathologising it
- Use a paced breathing technique correctly, having practised it in the room rather than watched it
- Apply one grounding technique that works while seated in a classroom without anyone noticing
- Distinguish avoidance that feels like relief from avoidance that makes the next time harder

From \$400

Supporting an Anxious Child

Parents leave with specific words for specific moments, and an understanding of why the instinct to remove the difficulty is the thing making it worse.

Audience Parents and carers

Duration 90 minutes, evening

Format On-site or virtual

Group size No cap on-site; virtual capped at 100 so questions stay answerable

Participants leave able to:

- Explain why accommodating anxiety strengthens it, in terms they could repeat to a partner
- Respond to a refusal to go to school using a prepared sequence rather than improvising at 7:40am
- Replace reassurance-seeking cycles with a response that does not feed them
- Distinguish supporting a child through difficulty from removing the difficulty

\$550 on-site · \$400 virtual · \$750 bundled with a same-day student session

The Jump: Preparing for Life After High School

Students leave with a concrete plan for the first six weeks after they leave, and a realistic picture of what actually goes wrong.

Audience Students, Grades 11–12

Duration 75 minutes

Format On-site assembly or classroom scale, or virtual

Group size Single class up to a full grade cohort

Participants leave able to:

- Predict the three or four specific structures they will lose in September and name a replacement for each
- Build a first-six-weeks plan covering sleep, food, money, and one social commitment
- Recognise the difference between normal adjustment difficulty and something that needs help
- Locate the mental health service at their destination institution before they arrive, not during a crisis

From \$450

The Regulated Classroom: Trauma-Informed Practice

Staff leave able to tell a dysregulated student from a defiant one, and to change their first response so it lowers the temperature instead of raising it.

Audience Teaching staff, educational assistants, and school leadership

Duration Half day (3 hours) or full day (6 hours)

Format On-site or virtual

Group size Up to 60 for the half day; capped at 30 for the full day so the practice labs work

Participants leave able to:

- Distinguish a dysregulated student from a defiant one using observable signals, not background assumptions
- Deliver a first response that lowers arousal rather than escalating it, practised aloud
- Explain to a colleague why a consequence delivered mid-escalation does not land
- Identify the predictable flashpoints in their own timetable and change one of them

Half day \$1,100 · Full day \$1,900 · Virtual half day \$800

What it costs

Student sessions

Steady: Understanding Anxiety and Building Coping Skills Grades 4–6, 7–8, 9–12 · 60–75 min	From \$400
The Jump: Preparing for Life After High School Grades 11–12 · 75 min	From \$450
Friendship, Conflict and Repair Grades 6–9 · 75 min	From \$400

More than one session in a visit

Two sessions in one visit	\$650
Three sessions in one visit	\$850

Staff training

The Regulated Classroom: Trauma-Informed Practice Half day	\$1,100
The Regulated Classroom: Trauma-Informed Practice Full day	\$1,900
The Regulated Classroom: Trauma-Informed Practice Virtual half day	\$800
Holding the Room: De-escalation and Dysregulated Students Half day, up to 30 staff	\$1,200
Holding the Room: De-escalation and Dysregulated Students Half day, up to 60 staff	\$1,600
Holding the Room: De-escalation and Dysregulated Students Virtual	\$900
Staying in the Work: Burnout, Boundaries and Staff Wellbeing 90-minute PD slot	\$650
Staying in the Work: Burnout, Boundaries and Staff Wellbeing Half day	\$1,100
Staying in the Work: Burnout, Boundaries and Staff Wellbeing Virtual 90 min	\$450

Parent evenings

Supporting an Anxious Child 90 minutes, evening, on-site	\$550
Supporting an Anxious Child Virtual	\$400
Supporting an Anxious Child Bundled with a same-day student session	\$750

Annual programs

Foundation

\$4,200/year

- Two student sessions
- One 90-minute staff session
- One parent evening
- Email consultation through the school year

Standard

\$7,400/year

MOST SCHOOLS START HERE

- Four student sessions across grade bands
- One half-day staff PD
- One 90-minute staff session
- Two parent evenings
- Student wellbeing policy review
- Email and phone consultation

Comprehensive

\$11,500/year

- Six student sessions
- Two half-day staff PD sessions
- Two parent evenings
- Policy review plus annual check-in
- One critical incident response day held on call
- Named wellbeing programming you can reference in admissions materials

Travel outside the Greater Toronto Area is quoted separately. Multi-session and annual bookings are discounted as shown.

Ballast Wellbeing delivers training and education. We do not provide counselling, assessment, or treatment. Every session includes a certificate of completion showing contact hours, verifiable at ballastwellbeing.com/verify.